

K. RAMKRISHNA, 58

DESIGNATION:
General Manager
Risk Department,
IDBI Bank

**ACADEMIC
QUALIFICATION:**
MA (economics)
and MBA

**"Nobody can fool
me just because
I cannot see."**

KANCHAN PAMNANI, 42

DESIGNATION:
Advocate and
solicitor, Pamnani
& Pamnani

**ACADEMIC
QUALIFICATION:**
B.Com & LLM

**"Technology and my
career saved me."**



it's easy for its differently-able professionals to function seamlessly. IBM's enabling policy revolves around accommodation, accessibility and attitude. From physical infrastructure to workforce sensitisation, the company takes care of all aspects of integration. However, as far as performance goes, there are no concessions made for these professionals.

No surprise then that IBM had no problems hiring a visually challenged Rajesh Mehta from Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS) while a leading private bank refused to even interview him on campus. Says Madana Kumar, head of training and development, IBM India and South Asia: "Rajesh is like anybody else and we give him support in terms of accessibility but other than that he is treated on a par with the rest." Having joined staffing solutions department, 26-year-old Mehta is now a key facilitator.

While a vast majority of companies in India still have initial reservations on recruiting such special people, K. Ramkrishna, general manager (risk management), IDBI Bank, believes that there's always the right job for the right

person. Having lost his vision at the age of 11 years was the only setback in his life, when he had to drop five years out of his academic life. But having gone back to school, with support from his teachers and friends, he not only graduated with economics but even went on to do an MBA from the SP Jain Institute of Management and Research because that was a dream he had. Having completed his management education, IDBI offered him a position during campus placements in 1985. Recalls Ramkrishna: "Back then, technology was not available, so I was given an assistant to read out the documents to me. But after the 1990s, when screen reading software came about, I don't even need that support."

Considering his job, which is to evaluate and sanction finance for projects, he has to deal with a lot of confidential information and numbers. Ask him how he verifies that the document is authentic and whether he is signing the right one, and he fishes out his latest Nokia N-Series mobile phone and clicks a picture of the file in front of him and the mobile phone